hypothesis, proposed by ecologists Wendy M. Ridenour and Ragan M. Callaway in 2004, which posits that invasive species have biochemical weapons that give them a key advantage over native species.



Garlic mustard is highly invasive in North America, inhibiting other plants. In its native habitat, it is considered an attractive wildflower, although it can have a strong smell.

The art of control

Successful invasive species are extremely difficult to control and almost impossible to eradicate. If the species is a plant, the most obvious way to remove it is to pull it up or cut it down, but such methods are highly labor-intensive, especially over a wide area. The use of chemicals to destroy